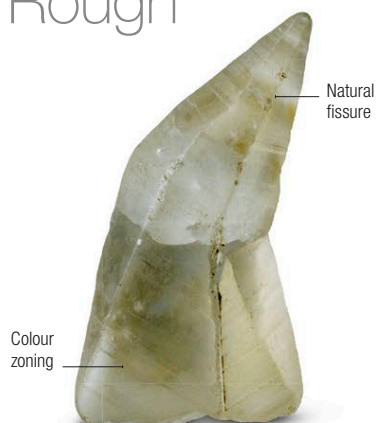
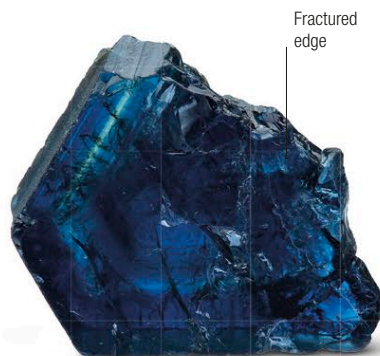


Rough



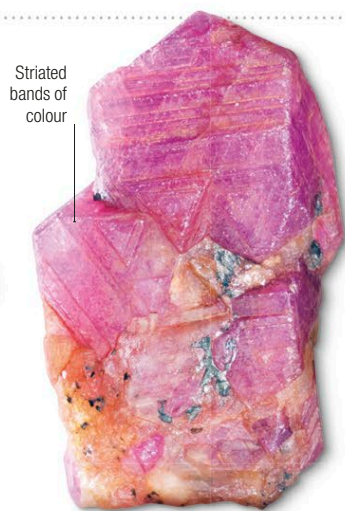
Colourless rough | This crystal has the classic corundum prismatic shape, with a triangular termination. Colourless sapphire may also be described as white.



Sapphire rough | This unusually large rough specimen of sapphire, around 22mm (1in) in length, displays a fine deep blue colouring. It also shows a number of imperfections.



Sapphire gravels | These uncut sapphires come from Philipsburg, Montana. For sheer volume, the US state of Montana is the world's most prolific producer of sapphires.



Padparadscha | The rare pink-orange variety of sapphire has its own name, as opposed to being described by its colour. Most padparadscha comes from Sri Lanka.

Cut and colour



Oblong step | A large table brings out the colour of sapphire. Blue is the most highly prized hue, and is given its colour by traces of titanium and iron.



Oval-cut green sapphire | Green is often found to be bands of yellow and blue sapphire, but skilful cutting of unevenly coloured stones yields gems with a uniform appearance.



Mixed-cut yellow sapphire | Skilful cutting reveals this stone's even yellow colour, its transparency enhanced by the brilliant cut that accentuates highlights and shadows.



Colourless brilliant cut | Colourless sapphires are often cut with multiple facets to catch the light and make the most of their adamantine or vitreous (glassy) lustre.

Jean Harlow

Sapphire on the screen

According to Hollywood legend, actress Jean Harlow accepted leading man William Powell's marriage proposal in 1936, but refused his offer of a diamond ring. The platinum-blond bombshell felt that a large star sapphire would better suit her personal style, and Powell duly purchased one. The ring can be seen in the romantic comedy *Personal Property*, as Harlow wore it on set during her performance – the last of her tragically curtailed career.



Jean Harlow Harlow's sapphire engagement ring can be seen in this still from the film *Personal Property*, 1937, the year she died.



Synthetic sapphire | This oblong stone features a brilliant cut. Once faceted, this variety of synthetic sapphire shows a full tonal range of pinks.



Star of Asia | Some sapphires such as this display asterism, a star-like pattern seen when cut *en cabochon*. It is caused by tiny intersecting inclusions of rutile.